

DOCUMENT 37

SPONSOR FULFILLMENT, ACTIVATION & RELATIONSHIP MANAGEMENT PLAYBOOK

What Happens After a Sponsor or Partner Says YES

Purpose: Ensure every confirmed sponsor, donor and strategic partner receives professional follow-through. This playbook governs confirmation, contribution collection, benefit fulfillment, activation, documentation, communication, impact reporting and renewal preparation.

THE NON-NEGOTIABLE RULE

Never sell or promise an approved benefit and then forget to deliver it. Every commitment must have an owner, deadline, status and proof of completion. A sponsor relationship is not complete when the contribution arrives; that is when fulfillment begins.

1. FROM YES TO ACTIVE PARTNER

#	Stage	Required Action
1	Confirm	Document exactly what the organization agreed to provide and any conditions.
2	Approve	Leadership confirms benefits, language, branding, legal/compliance requirements and activation plan.
3	Document	Complete required agreement, invoice/donation paperwork or written in-kind confirmation.
4	Receive	Track payment, product, tickets, services, media inventory or other contribution.
5	Onboard	Collect sponsor contacts, logo files, brand guidelines, deadlines and communication preferences.
6	Fulfill	Deliver every approved recognition/benefit on time.
7	Activate	Execute approved event, media, experience, mentoring, product or community activation.
8	Document	Capture appropriate photos, screenshots, attendance/engagement data and proof.
9	Report	Provide an accurate impact/fulfillment summary.
10	Thank & Renew	Thank the partner, maintain the relationship and plan the next conversation.

2. SPONSOR ONBOARDING CHECKLIST

Item	Record / Verify
Contribution	Cash amount or exact in-kind contribution; quantity/value; restrictions.
Documentation	Agreement, invoice/donation paperwork, purchase order or written confirmation as required.
Primary Contact	Day-to-day sponsor contact plus decision-maker/executive contact where appropriate.
Internal Owner	One person accountable for the relationship and fulfillment.
Logo	Approved high-resolution/vector logo and correct brand name.
Brand Guidelines	Colors, clear space, trademark requirements and prohibited uses.
Approved Benefits	Exact recognition/activation items promised.
Deadlines	Payment, logo, materials, event, activation, reporting and renewal dates.
Announcement	Whether/when the partnership may be announced and approved wording.
Special Requirements	Insurance, compliance, accessibility, safety, travel, venue, legal or procurement requirements.

3. SPONSOR FULFILLMENT TRACKER

Every approved benefit becomes a separate fulfillment task. Never store the promise only inside an email thread.

Benefit	Deliverable	Owner	Deadline	Proof
Website Recognition	Logo/name placement	Web / Design	Due date	Screenshot + URL
Event Signage	Approved logo/name on signage	Events / Design	Due date	Photo
Social Recognition	Approved acknowledgment post	Communications	Due date	Post screenshot/link
Program Materials	Logo/name on approved material	Design	Print deadline	Final PDF/photo
Event Recognition	Verbal/on-screen acknowledgment	Event Lead	Event date	Run-of-show + photo/video
Tickets / Products	Receive, inventory and distribute correctly	Operations	Distribution date	Receipt + distribution log
Travel / Experience	Confirm eligibility, restrictions and logistics	Leadership / Operations	Experience date	Confirmation + approved proof
Mentor / Speaker	Schedule, brief and supervise approved engagement	Program Lead	Session date	Attendance + approved photo
Media	Deliver creative/materials and track donated inventory	Communications	Campaign dates	Screenshots / media report
Impact Report	Send accurate fulfillment/outcome report	Relationship Owner	Report date	Sent copy + CRM note

4. CONTRIBUTION RECEIPT & CONTROL

Cash: Track invoice/donation request date, payment status, amount received, date received and internal accounting handoff. **In-kind:** Track quantity, description, restrictions, documented/verified value, delivery date, storage and distribution. **Services/media:** Track scope, dates, deliverables and evidence of completion.

Fellows should never personally collect, hold or redirect sponsor funds. Financial transactions, tax documentation and formal receipts must follow the organization's authorized financial process.

5. BRAND & LOGO MANAGEMENT

- Use only the logo supplied or approved by the sponsor.
- Do not stretch, recolor, redraw or alter a sponsor logo unless brand guidelines permit it.
- Use the correct legal/brand name in public materials.
- Do not imply endorsement beyond the confirmed relationship.
- Do not place a sponsor into a higher recognition level than approved.
- Do not announce the sponsor before the approved announcement date.
- Save approval of unusual logo/branding usage when required.
- Remove or update recognition when the agreed term ends, if applicable.

6. ACTIVATION TYPES

Activation	Fulfillment Considerations
Awards / Scholarships	Approved support for student, teacher or school awards; ensure eligibility and administration rules are followed.
Event Activation	Booth/table, signage, stage acknowledgment, product sampling or other approved event presence.
Employee Engagement	Mentors, judges where independent judging rules permit, speakers, volunteers or career professionals.
STEM / Career Experience	Workplace visit, demonstration, campus visit, technology session or approved career exposure.
Product / Prize	Devices, gift cards, tickets, supplies, apparel, food or other approved items.
Travel / Hospitality	Airfare, hotel, resort or experience; document restrictions, taxes/fees, age, guardianship and logistics.
Media / Awareness	Billboards, radio, TV, print, digital/social inventory or approved distribution.
Community Distribution	Sponsor helps eligible students/families discover the program through its network.

7. DOCUMENT THE IMPACT - BUT PROTECT STUDENTS

Collect appropriate evidence such as approved photos, event images, screenshots of recognition, distribution counts, program participation metrics and stories. Use only information the program is authorized to share. Follow consent/privacy requirements for minors and do not give sponsors direct access to participant contact information.

Never stage or exaggerate impact. If 83 students participated in an activation, report 83—not 'hundreds.' If a sponsor donated 100 tickets and 74 were distributed, record both numbers accurately.

8. SPONSOR COMMUNICATION CADENCE

Timing	Communication
Immediately after confirmation	Thank them; confirm next steps, documentation and owner.
During onboarding	Collect logo, brand rules, contacts, contribution details and deadlines.
Before activation	Confirm logistics, approved recognition and responsibilities.
After activation	Send a short thank-you/update with appropriate proof.
Major program milestones	Share meaningful, relevant progress—not constant generic emails.
Impact report	Summarize fulfillment, verified reach/outcomes and approved stories/photos.
Renewal window	Begin before the current relationship expires or next budget cycle closes.

9. RELATIONSHIP MANAGEMENT: DO NOT DISAPPEAR AFTER THE CHECK

The relationship owner should know the sponsor's goals, key contacts, contribution history, activation preferences and next budget cycle. Send useful updates and invite the sponsor to appropriate program moments. Relationship building means showing that the organization values the partner beyond the transaction.

10. WHEN SOMETHING GOES WRONG

Issue	Response
Benefit may be late	Tell leadership immediately; create a recovery plan and communicate proactively when appropriate.
Logo/material error	Correct it quickly; document replacement/correction.
Activation changes	Do not improvise material changes without approval; confirm revised scope.
Sponsor requests unapproved benefit	Record request and escalate; do not promise.
Contribution delayed	Follow authorized finance/relationship process; keep fulfillment dependencies clear.
In-kind item unavailable	Discuss approved substitute/value pathway with leadership and sponsor.
Safety/privacy concern	Stop the affected activity and escalate before proceeding.
Sponsor behavior conflicts with program standards	Escalate to leadership; relationship value does not override student safety or program integrity.

11. SPONSOR HEALTH SCORE

Factor	Score	Measure
Contribution received	0-2	Received on time and correctly documented.
Fulfillment	0-2	All approved benefits on track/completed.
Engagement	0-2	Sponsor is responsive and participating appropriately.
Impact alignment	0-2	Partnership is delivering the intended strategic value.
Relationship strength	0-2	Strong contact relationship and positive communication.
Renewal potential	0-2	Clear opportunity and timing for continued support.

Interpretation: 10-12 = strong/renewal-ready; 7-9 = healthy but improve; 4-6 = at risk; 0-3 = leadership intervention required.

12. RENEWAL PREPARATION

Do not wait until the partnership has expired. Before the sponsor's next budget cycle, prepare a concise record of contribution, benefits delivered, verified impact, highlights, lessons and the next opportunity. Ask what worked for them and what they would want to change. Renewal should build on

evidence, not simply repeat last year's request.

13. FINAL FULFILLMENT CHECKLIST

Contribution → Documentation → Payment/In-Kind Received → Sponsor Onboarded → Logo/Brand Approved → Benefits Entered → Owners Assigned → Activation Completed → Proof Collected → Impact Report Sent → Thank You Completed → Renewal Date Scheduled

14. RELATIONSHIP PRINCIPLE

Treat every sponsor like a relationship you hope to keep for years. Deliver what was promised, communicate clearly, protect students, report accurately and make the partner proud of the impact they helped create.

PROGRAM CONTACT

Frantz Coutard

Founder, Student Impact Challenge

Founder & President, TrendCatch Gives Back Inc.

Email: Info@frantzcoutard.com

Cell: 516-697-6962

Website: FrantzCoutard.com